SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

11 September 2023 · Shift 1

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 42 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 2 questions

Q.1

If the selling price of 16 bulbs is equal to the cost price of 24 bulbs, what is the profit percentage?

(A) 40%
(B) 50%
(C) 25%
(D) 20%

Q.15

In some quantity of water ,four times the quantity of milk is added and the quantity of the mixture is now 7.5 litres. How much more milk is to be added to the mixture to have 90% milk in the mixture ?

(A) 9 liters
(B) 9.5 liters
(C) 6 liters
(D) 7.5 liters

General Awareness 22 questions

Q.1

What is the purpose of a savings account?

(A) Obtaining a mortgage loan
(B) Earning interest on deposits
(C) Making day-to-day transactions
(D) Paying bills online

Q.2

According to the Census of India 2011, the female literacy rate was recorded as _____.

(A) 75.35%
(B) 65.46%
(C) 55.84%
(D) 70.24%

Q.3

Which of the following crops is most suitable for black soil?

(A) Soybean
(B) Maize
(C) Cotton
(D) Barley

Q.4

In India, the ‘Aus’, ‘Aman’ and ‘Boro’ terms are associated with which crop from the following?

(A) Wheat
(B) Gram
(C) Sugarcane
(D) Paddy

Q.5
The President of India conferred the Padma Shri award to Gurcharan Singh for his distinguished service in the field of _____ in 2023.

(A) Tennis
(B) Cricket
(C) Football
(D) Badminton

Q.6
Who moved the resolution proposing that the National Flag of India be a 'horizontal tricolour of saffron, white and dark green in equal proportion'?

(A) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(B) Jawaharlal Nehru
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Dr Rajendra Prasad

Q.7
In which of the following States was the first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav held?

(A) Odisha
(B) Chhattisgarh
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Andhra Pradesh

Q.8
Identify the Indian singer who sang the song 'Ae mere watan ke logon jara akhon mein bharlo paani…' before the first Prime Minister of India, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru.

(A) Lata Mangeshkar
(B) Mohammad Rafi
(C) Mukesh
(D) Asha Bhosle

Q.9
Which regulatory body in India is responsible for overseeing and regulating Micro Finance Institutions?

(A) Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
(B) Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)
(C) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)
(D) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)

Q.10
Who among the following was the viceroy of India at the time of India's independence from colonial rule on 15 August 1947?

(A) Lord Wavell
(B) Lord Willingdon
(C) Lord Mountbatten
(D) Lord Linlithgow

Q.11
Which of the following is the legislative organ of the Union Government?

(A) Cabinet
(B) Supreme Court
(C) Executive
(D) Parliament

Q.12
Due to rapid urbanisation, the human lifestyle has changed severely; obesity is a major health issue in such condition. Which of the following is a reason for obesity?

(A) Excessive consumption of water
(B) Excessive intake of high calorie foods
(C) Lack of protein
(D) Lack of vitamins in regular diet

Q.14
Where was Shree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam founded?

(A) Tamil Nādu
(B) Kerala
(C) Karnataka
(D) Telangana

Q.15
Who is the renowned kathak dancer, student of 'Pandit Birju Maharaj' and also served as an officer with Indian Audit and Accounts Services?

(A) Sonal Mansingh
(B) Guru Bipin Singh
(C) Shovana Narayan
(D) Padma Subrahmanayam

Q.17
Which of the following Indus Valley sites is now located in Pakistan?

(A) Harappa
(B) Lothal
(C) Alamgirpur
(D) Kalibangan

Q.18
In April 2023,Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty made history, becoming the first Indian men's doubles pair to win a gold medal at the Badminton Asia Championships. Where was this championship held?

(A) Singapore
(B) Dubai
(C) Qatar
(D) Malaysia

Q.19
Which of the following states has introduced a dedicated Semiconductor Policy 2022-27 with a view to generate at least 2,00,000 new employment opportunities in the state?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Gujarat
(D) Kerala

Q.20
The classical dance style of Bharatanatyam belongs to the state of _____.

(A) Karnataka
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Assam
(D) Rajasthan

Q.21
Which of the following peninsular rivers of India is a west flowing river?

(A) Kaveri
(B) Narmada
(C) Godavari
(D) Krishna

Q.22
Which Articles of the Constitution of India deal with the Union and its territory?

(A) Articles 5-11
(B) Articles 1-4
(C) Articles 12-35
(D) Article 36-51

Q.23
'The Great Indian Novel' is a satirical novel by _____.

(A) Suryakant Tripathi
(B) KR Narayan
(C) Munshi Prem Chand
(D) Shashi Tharoor

Q.24
What is the systematic name of a colourless gas with a faint, ethereal odour called acetylene, widely used for welding?

(A) Ethyne
(B) Ethanoic anhydride
(C) Azoethane
(D) Ethyl acetate

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part that contains an error. (A) Taylor, Richard, and / (B) Francis plays for / (C) the state / (D) basketball team.

(A) D
(B) A
(C) C
(D) B

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pay an arm and a leg for something

(A) Be devoted to unwanted things
(B) Pay a lot of money for something
(C) Give a lot of love and care to someone
(D) Pay a lot of attention to an incident

Q.3

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. As they driven through the dark, twisting lane / down which they had walked earlier, Lucius heard / the whistling of the night air in his ears.

(A) down which they had walked earlier, Lucius heard
(B) No error
(C) the whistling of the night air in his ears.
(D) As they driven through the dark, twisting lane

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Trivial

(A) Minor
(B) Fatal
(C) Decisive
(D) Formal

Q.5

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Ministry of education has announced that students can _____ the Board Examinations twice.

(A) take
(B) participate
(C) give
(D) get

Q.6

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. A man of character, he "stuck to his guns" even in the most difficult situations.

(A) To do things that would please people
(B) To behave disrespectfully
(C) To find a treasure
(D) To stand firm against all difficulties and challenges

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. After her husband passed away, Jane had to learn "to bite the bullet" and take care of the household on her own.

(A) Create a difficult situation
(B) Accept a difficult situation bravely
(C) Criticise someone harshly
(D) Run away from a difficult situation

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. One who lends money to others at a very high rate of interest.

(A) Curator
(B) Bankrupt
(C) Usurer
(D) Numismatist

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. The platinum is a precious metal.

(A) is
(B) The platinum
(C) a
(D) precious metal

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. All praised him when he soared in the business world, but the same people _____ him when he failed in business.

(A) nourished
(B) criticised
(C) supported
(D) dramatised

Q.11

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. What “most off” us “want most” “is to” “move forward”.

(A) most off
(B) is to
(C) want most
(D) move forward

Q.12

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. That which can’t be read.

(A) Inaccessible
(B) Incurable
(C) Illegible
(D) Irrelevant

Q.13

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Acknowlege
(B) Territory
(C) Excellence
(D) Business

Q.14

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Authentic

(A) Moderate
(B) Actual
(C) False
(D) Wise

Q.15

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Please tell me about the meeting _____.

(A) in a nutshell
(B) in a stew
(C) in a huff
(D) in a spin

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Augmented Reality (AR) continues to develop and become more _____ among a wide range of applications.

(A) rare
(B) amicable
(C) idealistic
(D) pervasive

Q.18

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. The handloom shop at the Ring Road has many kinds of bags, such as paper, leather, cloth and cannvas.

(A) Paper
(B) Cannvas
(C) Leather
(D) Cloth

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A/An _____ fellow cannot become an ideal teacher.

(A) idle
(B) bright
(C) intelligent
(D) honest

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I considered Geography as “an easier” subject.

(A) the easy
(B) the easier
(C) an easiest
(D) an easy

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most common hazard in forests is forest fire. Forest fires are as old as the forests themselves. They pose a 1._____ not only to the forest wealth but also to the entire regime to fauna and flora seriously disturbing the biodiversity and the ecology and environment of a region. During summer, when there is no rain for months, the forests 2._____ littered with dry senescent leaves and twinges, which could burst into flames ignited by the slightest spark. The Himalayan forests, particularly, Garhwal Himalayas have been burning 3._____ during the last few summers, with colossal loss of vegetation cover of that region. The youngest mountain ranges of the Himalayas are the most 4._____ stretches of the world susceptible to forest fires. The forests of the Western are more 5._____ vulnerable to forest fires as compared to those in the Eastern Himalayas. This is because forests of the Eastern Himalayas grow in high rain density.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

(A) mercy
(B) trend
(C) failure
(D) threat

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most common hazard in forests is forest fire. Forest fires are as old as the forests themselves. They pose a 1._____ not only to the forest wealth but also to the entire regime to fauna and flora seriously disturbing the biodiversity and the ecology and environment of a region. During summer, when there is no rain for months, the forests 2._____ littered with dry senescent leaves and twinges, which could burst into flames ignited by the slightest spark. The Himalayan forests, particularly, Garhwal Himalayas have been burning 3._____ during the last few summers, with colossal loss of vegetation cover of that region. The youngest mountain ranges of the Himalayas are the most 4._____ stretches of the world susceptible to forest fires. The forests of the Western are more 5._____ vulnerable to forest fires as compared to those in the Eastern Himalayas. This is because forests of the Eastern Himalayas grow in high rain density.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

(A) keep
(B) build
(C) become
(D) drive

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most common hazard in forests is forest fire. Forest fires are as old as the forests themselves. They pose a 1._____ not only to the forest wealth but also to the entire regime to fauna and flora seriously disturbing the biodiversity and the ecology and environment of a region. During summer, when there is no rain for months, the forests 2._____ littered with dry senescent leaves and twinges, which could burst into flames ignited by the slightest spark. The Himalayan forests, particularly, Garhwal Himalayas have been burning 3._____ during the last few summers, with colossal loss of vegetation cover of that region. The youngest mountain ranges of the Himalayas are the most 4._____ stretches of the world susceptible to forest fires. The forests of the Western are more 5._____ vulnerable to forest fires as compared to those in the Eastern Himalayas. This is because forests of the Eastern Himalayas grow in high rain density.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

(A) rarely
(B) regularly
(C) badly
(D) enough

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most common hazard in forests is forest fire. Forest fires are as old as the forests themselves. They pose a 1._____ not only to the forest wealth but also to the entire regime to fauna and flora seriously disturbing the biodiversity and the ecology and environment of a region. During summer, when there is no rain for months, the forests 2._____ littered with dry senescent leaves and twinges, which could burst into flames ignited by the slightest spark. The Himalayan forests, particularly, Garhwal Himalayas have been burning 3._____ during the last few summers, with colossal loss of vegetation cover of that region. The youngest mountain ranges of the Himalayas are the most 4._____ stretches of the world susceptible to forest fires. The forests of the Western are more 5._____ vulnerable to forest fires as compared to those in the Eastern Himalayas. This is because forests of the Eastern Himalayas grow in high rain density.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

(A) outrageous
(B) vulnerable
(C) greasy
(D) mysterious

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The most common hazard in forests is forest fire. Forest fires are as old as the forests themselves. They pose a 1._____ not only to the forest wealth but also to the entire regime to fauna and flora seriously disturbing the biodiversity and the ecology and environment of a region. During summer, when there is no rain for months, the forests 2._____ littered with dry senescent leaves and twinges, which could burst into flames ignited by the slightest spark. The Himalayan forests, particularly, Garhwal Himalayas have been burning 3._____ during the last few summers, with colossal loss of vegetation cover of that region. The youngest mountain ranges of the Himalayas are the most 4._____ stretches of the world susceptible to forest fires. The forests of the Western are more 5._____ vulnerable to forest fires as compared to those in the Eastern Himalayas. This is because forests of the Eastern Himalayas grow in high rain density.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

(A) closely
(B) frequently
(C) deeply
(D) barely

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**		

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (B) 50%

Take the cost of one bulb as ₹1: 16 bulbs cost ₹16 and sell for ₹24, a profit of ₹8 on ₹16, or 8/16 × 100 = 50%.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 7.5 liters

Water x and milk 4x make 5x = 7.5 litres, so there are 1.5 litres of water and 6 of milk. For 90% milk the 1.5 litres of water must be 10% of the mixture, which must then be 15 litres: 15 – 7.5 = 7.5 litres more milk.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Earning interest on deposits

A savings account is meant for keeping savings safely while they earn interest; the account meant for frequent, day-to-day business transactions is the current account.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 65.46%

The provisional figures of Census 2011, the ones usually cited, put the literacy rate of females (aged seven and above) at 65.46%, against 82.14% for males.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Cotton

Black soil (regur), which holds moisture well, is so suited to cotton that it is also called black cotton soil. Soybean is grown on it too, but cotton is the crop it is known for.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Paddy

Aus, aman and boro are the three rice (paddy) crops of the year in West Bengal and Assam, harvested in autumn, winter and summer respectively.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Cricket

Gurcharan Singh, the Delhi cricket coach who trained many Test and first-class cricketers and received the Dronacharya Award in 1987, was given the Padma Shri in 2023.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Jawaharlal Nehru

Jawaharlal Nehru moved the resolution on the National Flag in the Constituent Assembly on 22 July 1947, and the Assembly adopted it that day.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Odisha

The first Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav, a national sports festival for tribal athletes, was held at KIIT, Bhubaneswar, Odisha, in June 2023.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Lata Mangeshkar

Lata Mangeshkar sang Kavi Pradeep's 'Ae Mere Watan Ke Logon', a tribute to the soldiers who died in the 1962 war with China, in Delhi in January 1963 in Nehru's presence.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

Microfinance institutions set up as NBFC-MFIs are regulated by the Reserve Bank of India, whose 2022 rules for microfinance loans also cover the banks and other NBFCs that make such loans. SIDBI and NABARD fund and promote microfinance but do not regulate it.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Lord Mountbatten

Lord Mountbatten, who succeeded Lord Wavell in March 1947, was the last Viceroy; at independence he became the first Governor-General of the Dominion of India.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Parliament

Under Article 79 Parliament, made up of the President and the two Houses, is the Union's legislature; the Cabinet belongs to the executive and the Supreme Court to the judiciary.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Excessive intake of high calorie foods
Obesity results when more energy is taken in than the body uses, so a habit of eating high-calorie foods leads to fat building up in the body.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Kerala
The Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana (SNDP) Yogam was founded in Kerala in 1903, with Sree Narayana Guru as its president, to work for the social uplift of the Ezhava community.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Shovana Narayan
Shovana Narayan, a Kathak dancer trained by Pandit Birju Maharaj, also had a career as an officer of the Indian Audit and Accounts Service.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Harappa
Harappa, on the Ravi, is in Punjab province, Pakistan. Lothal is in Gujarat, Kalibangan in Rajasthan and Alamgirpur in Uttar Pradesh.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Dubai
Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty won the men's doubles title at the 2023 Badminton Asia Championships in Dubai on 30 April 2023.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Gujarat
Gujarat, the first state with a dedicated semiconductor policy, announced its Semiconductor Policy 2022-27 in July 2022, aiming at 2,00,000 new jobs over five years.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu
Bharatanatyam is the classical dance of Tamil Nadu.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Narmada
The Narmada flows west through a rift valley into the Arabian Sea; the Kaveri, Godavari and Krishna flow east into the Bay of Bengal.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Articles 1-4
Part I of the Constitution, Articles 1-4, deals with the Union and its territory. Articles 5-11 deal with citizenship, 12-35 with Fundamental Rights and 36-51 with the Directive Principles.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Shashi Tharoor
Shashi Tharoor's 'The Great Indian Novel' (1989) retells the Mahabharata as the story of India's freedom movement and its aftermath.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Ethyne
Acetylene, C_2H_2, is the simplest alkyne, and its systematic (IUPAC) name is ethyne; it burns with oxygen in the oxy-acetylene torch used for welding.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) B
Subjects joined by 'and' take a plural verb: 'Taylor, Richard, and Francis play for the state basketball team.'

Q.2 · Answer (B) Pay a lot of money for something
To 'pay an arm and a leg' for something is to pay a very high price for it.

Q.3 · Answer (D) As they driven through the dark, twisting lane
'Driven' is a past participle and cannot stand alone as the verb; the simple past is needed: 'As they drove through the dark, twisting lane'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Minor
'Trivial' means of little importance: 'minor'.

Q.5 · Answer (A) take
In standard English a candidate 'takes' (or sits) an examination and the examiner 'gives' it; 'participate' would need 'in'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) To stand firm against all difficulties and challenges
To 'stick to one's guns' is to hold firmly to one's position in spite of opposition or difficulty.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Accept a difficult situation bravely
To 'bite the bullet' is to face something difficult or unpleasant with courage.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Usurer
A 'usurer' lends money at very high interest. A curator looks after a museum's collection and a numismatist studies or collects coins.

Q.9 · Answer (B) The platinum
The name of a metal used in a general sense takes no article: 'Platinum is a precious metal.'

Q.10 · Answer (B) criticised
'But' sets the failure against the praise, so the same people 'criticised' him.

Q.11 · Answer (A) most off
The preposition 'of' is needed, not 'off': 'What most of us want most is to move forward.'

Q.12 · Answer (C) Illegible
Writing that cannot be read is 'illegible'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Acknowlege
The correct spelling is 'acknowledge'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) False
'Authentic' means genuine or real; its opposite is 'false'. 'Actual' is close in meaning to it.

Q.15 · Answer (A) in a nutshell
'In a nutshell' means briefly, in a few words. 'In a stew' and 'in a spin' mean worried or confused, and 'in a huff' annoyed.

Q.16 · Answer (D) pervasive
'Pervasive' means spreading widely through something, as AR is spreading through more and more applications.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Cannvas
The correct spelling is 'canvas'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) idle
An 'idle' (lazy) person cannot become an ideal teacher; the other options are qualities a good teacher has.

Q.20 · Answer (D) an easy
Nothing is compared with Geography, so the positive degree is needed, not the comparative: 'an easy subject'.

Q.21 · Answer (D) threat
Fires 'pose a threat' to the forest wealth: they put it in danger.

Q.22 · Answer (C) become
With no rain for months, the forests 'become' littered with dry leaves and twigs: the verb shows a change of state.

Q.23 · Answer (B) regularly
SSC's key gives 'regularly': 'during the last few summers' points to fires that have come back summer after summer. 'Badly' would describe how fierce the fires were, but 'burning badly' is not a natural way to say that of a forest.

Q.24 · Answer (B) vulnerable

'Vulnerable' means open to harm, which matches 'susceptible to forest fires': the young Himalayan ranges are among the most vulnerable stretches.

Q.25 · Answer (B) frequently

Fires break out more often in the western forests than in the eastern ones, which get more rain, so they are 'more frequently' vulnerable.

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